

Justification & Approval For Other than Full and Open Competition

As a legislative branch agency, the Library is subject to the competition and advertising requirements of 41 U.S.C. § 6101. Like the Competition in Contracting Act and the FAR, 41 U.S.C. § 6101 does not require competition when a contracting officer certifies that only one source or brand-name item is available, when dictated by public exigency, or when otherwise authorized by law.

This document sets forth the justification and approval for award of a contract or order by means providing for other than full and open competition per 41 U.S.C. § 6101, LCR 7-210, and, as applicable, FAR 6.302, FAR 13.106-1, FAR 8.405, and FAR 16.505. Contracting without competition shall not be justified on the basis of a lack of advance planning or concerns related to availability of funds.

This form shall be used to support instances where competition will be limited to a single source, a limited number of sources, including where a brand name product is required.

Part 1 – Identification

1. Contracting Agency and Activity: Library of Congress, Office of the Librarian, Center for Learning, Literacy and Engagement, Signature Programs Office

2. Nature of Action Being Approved

- ☒ Contract (or modification)
- ☐ LoC or Leg Branch Order (or modification)
- ☐ GSA Schedule or GWAC:
- ☐ Other:

Plan ID Number: 2025-CLL-0043
Contractor (or Brand Name): American Library Association (ALA)
Show Management Office
Estimated Value (Base and all options): XXXXXXXXXX
Period of Performance: 5-1-2025 through 7-1-2025

3. Description of Supplies or Services Required to Meet Library Needs

Describe the supplies or services that are required to meet the Library's minimum needs and the delivery schedule required to meet those needs. Do not focus on a description of the program.

The Library requires the following supplies or services:

The Library of Congress requires short-term rental space for its exhibit booth at the American Library Association (ALA) annual conference 2025. The conference sponsor American Library Association Show Management is the only source that can provide space rental at their conferences.

The exhibits at the ALA annual conference will be housed in the Philadelphia Convention Center in Philadelphia, PA. The exhibits will be open from Friday evening, June 27, 2025 through Monday afternoon, June 30, 2025. Set up for the exhibits begins on Wednesday, June 25, 2025 and the removal of the exhibits begins Monday afternoon, June 30, 2025.

Part 2 – Program Office Justification & Approval

4. Authority for Contracting Without Competition

Over \$250,000

For this requirement over \$250,000, under FAR part 6, the basis for contracting without providing for full and open competition is:

- ☐ There is only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy Library requirements. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(2)(C); FAR 6.302-1.
 - ☐ Library's minimum needs can only be satisfied by contractor's unique capabilities or products. FAR 6.302-1(b)(1).
 - ☐ Source controls copyrights, patents, raw materials, or secret processes cannot be acquired otherwise, or similar circumstances. FAR 6.302-1(b)(2).
 - ☐ Other exception identified in FAR 6.302-1: Identify the exception
- ☐ There is such unusual & compelling urgency that the Government would be seriously injured if competition is not limited. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(2)(B); FAR 6.302-2. Option years are not permitted.
- ☐ Source is expressly authorized or required by statute (e.g., AbilityOne, UNICOR, GPO, GSA Public Buildings Service, Appropriations Act, etc.) per 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 6.302-5: Identify the authority
- ☐ Other basis authorized in 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b) or FAR part 6.302: Identify the exception
- ☐ Library's needs can only be satisfied by a brand-name product or item which is essential to the Government's requirement. FAR 6.302-1(c).
- ☐ The Product is listed on the Library of Congress Enterprise Architecture Repository (LCEAR) database (Attach applicable IT Standard Data Sheet)

Up to and including \$250,000

For this requirement up to \$250,000, using simplified acquisition procedures under FAR part 13, the basis for contracting without providing for full and open competition is:

- ☒ Only one responsible source is reasonably available to meet Library requirements. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b); FAR 13.106-1.
 - ☒ Product or service is reasonably available from only one source.
 - ☐ Source controls copyrights, patents or other exclusive licensing arrangements.
 - ☐ Urgent circumstances; only one source can reasonably deliver by required date. Option years are not permitted.
 - ☐ Source is expressly authorized or required by statute: Identify the authority
- ☐ Library's needs can only be satisfied by a brand-name product
- ☐ The Product is listed the Library of Congress Enterprise Architecture Repository (LCEAR) database (Attach applicable IT Standard Data Sheet)

GSA Schedule Order

For this GSA schedule order under FAR part 8, the basis for not competing among GSA schedule-holders and/or specifying a brand name product or item is:

- ☐ An urgent and compelling need exists, and following GSA procedures would result in unacceptable delays. FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(A).
- ☐ Only one GSA source is capable of fulfilling the requirement at the level of quality required because the supplies or services are unique or highly specialized. FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(B).
- ☐ In the interest of economy and efficiency, the new work is a logical follow-on to an original order that was placed competitively among GSA schedule-holders (i.e., the original order was not sole-source or limited-source.) FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(i)(C).
- ☐ Library's needs can only be satisfied by a brand-name product
- ☐ The Product is listed on the Library of Congress Enterprise Architecture Repository (LCEAR) database (Attach applicable IT Standard Data Sheet)

Order Under Multiple Award Indefinite-Delivery Contract or GWAC

For this order under FAR subpart 16.5, the basis for contracting without providing for full and open competition is:

- ☐ The need is so urgent fair opportunity would result in unacceptable delays. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(2)(C) and FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(A).
- ☐ The Library's minimum needs can only be satisfied by contractor's unique capabilities or products. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(B).
- ☐ A logical follow-on order in the interest of economy and efficiency. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 16.505(b)(i)(2)(C).
- ☐ To satisfy a minimum guarantee. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 16.505(b)(2)(D).
- ☐ Authorized or required by statute. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(1) and FAR 16.505(b)(2)(E).
- ☐ The Library's minimum needs can only be satisfied by a brand-name product or item which is essential to the Government's requirement. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b)(2)(B) and FAR 16.505(a)(4)(i).
- ☐ The Product is listed on the Library of Congress Enterprise Architecture Repository (LCEAR) database (Attach applicable IT Standard Data Sheet)

5. Rationale for Contracting Without Competition

In supporting an action not providing for full and open competition, it is not sufficient to demonstrate that the contractor is exceptionally well qualified or even the best qualified, or that the required brand name product is well suited to the Library's needs. The rationale must demonstrate that no one else, or no other competing product, can satisfactorily fulfill the Library's requirement. Do not focus on the importance of the requirement; the issue is the rationale for not competing.

In supporting urgency, address the following: What are the unexpected facts or the unpredictable events that led to this situation? When is the required delivery or performance start date? Why this date? What specific harm to the Government will occur if the delivery is not made or performance not begun as scheduled? (Note that expiration of funds is not sufficient harm to justify not competing.) Demonstrate that the contract is only for items and quantities urgently needed until a competitive procurement action can be developed, or that a separate competitive follow-on is not practical.

In supporting a brand name justification, the brand name or feature must be essential to the Library's requirements, and market research indicates that other company's similar products or products with similar features cannot meet or be modified to meet the Library's needs.

We are authorized to limit competition on the basis of the citation in section 4 because:

The American Library Association (ALA) is the sponsor of the annual conference, and the ALA Show Management is the sole provider of exhibit space rental. Accordingly, the Library of Congress has no alternative but to rent space from the ALA Show Management.

The ALA annual conferences are held each June at different locations in the United States. ALA is the largest association of library and information professionals in the country. The Library has exhibited at the ALA annual conference for more than 20 years.

During the exhibits, the Library of Congress performs educational and outreach work at a national level by sharing information about the Library's collections, programs, and services with members of the broader library and information community, educators, and professionals in the field of information technologies to increase their awareness of resources from the national library available onsite and online.

6. Actions to Overcome Barriers to Competition Before Subsequent Contract Is Required

State what actions, if any, the program office can take to overcome barriers to competition before a contracting for this requirement again, such as: using action to provide time to develop specifications for a competitive procurement by a certain date; licensing copyrights or patents so other contractors may use the works; or breaking the requirement into parts that may be purchased competitively. If this is a one-time requirement, explain that action to increase future competition is not needed. If the source is expressly required by statute, state "Source is statutory."

To increase competition, we will:

The conference sponsor American Library Association (ALA) Show Management is the only source that can provide exhibit space rental at ALA conferences. The Library will continue to monitor the commercial marketplace to verify that only ALA can provide these services in the future.

7. Program Office Certification

I certify that the description of the Government's minimum needs, schedule requirements, and technical information that provide the basis for this justification are accurate and complete.

			01/09/2025
Name	Title	Signature	Date

PART 3 – CONTRACTING OFFICER DETERMINATIONS & CERTIFICATION

8. Efforts to Solicit from As Many Potential Sources As Practicable

Unless a justification is based on FAR 6.302-2, Unusual and compelling urgency, contracting officers shall post justifications for other than full and open competition, including brand name justifications, to the Contract Opportunities website on sam.gov (or eBuy for Brand Name Justifications under FAR Part 8) prior to requesting a proposal or otherwise entering into negotiations.

- ☐ Advance notice will be published in sam.gov for 15 days before a contract is awarded. FAR 5.203(a).
- ☐ Advance or concurrent notice will be published in sam.gov for a reasonable time for commercial items FAR 5.203(a) and 12.204(b).
- ☐ Advance notice will not be published because the action meets the following FAR exception:
- ☐ Notice would compromise national security. FAR 5.202(a)(1).
 - ☐ Unusual and compelling urgency; notice period would seriously injure Government. FAR 5.202(a)(2).
 - ☐ Expressly authorized or required to be made through another Government agency. FAR 5.202(a)(4).
 - ☐ Order will be placed against an IDIQ contract awarded under FAR 16.5. FAR 5.202(a)(6).
 - ☐ Order will be placed against GSA schedule or other competitively-awarded contract. FAR 5.202(a)(11).
 - ☒ Other: FAR 13.501(a)(1)(iii): Make publicly available the justification (excluding brand name) required by 6.305(a) within 14 days after contract award.
- ☐ Advance notice will not be published per 41 U.S.C. § 6101; see attached deviation from the FAR per LCR 7-210 § 3.A.

We made the following efforts to interest potential sources in this award: Notice of sole-source posted to SAM.gov within 14 days of contract award.

9. Listing of Sources That Expressed Interest in Writing

The following sources expressed interest in this award: None.

10. Additional Information

The following additional information is relevant to this justification and approval: N/A

11. Contracting Officer Determination that Price Is Fair and Reasonable

As explained in detail below, I have determined that the prices for this contracting action are fair and reasonable based on comparison of the prices to the following (see FAR 15.404-1(b)(2)):

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Historical prices paid by the Government | ☐ Published competitive price lists |
| ☐ Library's Independent Government Estimate | ☒ Prices obtained through market research |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Prices obtained through competitive proposals |

The following analysis supports my determination:

The Library of Congress established price reasonableness for this award through comparison with historical prices paid for these services, and through comparison of the price with publicly available price lists, per FAR 13.106-3(a)(2)(iii).

This year's pricing set by the ALA is \$30.00 per square foot or \$3,000 for a 10' x 10' booth. There is also an additional \$225 per corner. These rates are published on the ALA's conference website. All exhibitors at ALA must pay these prices.

12. Contracting Officer Determination of Responsibility

- ☒ Checked System for Award Management (or will check in the case of competitive proposals for a brand name product)

13. Contracting Officer Determination of Best Value

I have determined that this action represents the best value to the Government because:

The Library of Congress exhibits at ALA each year. Space rental services can only be provided by ALA, and these services are provided at fair and reasonable prices. For these reasons, the best value for this requirement is provided by ALA.

14. Contracting Officer Certification

I certify that, to the best of my knowledge and belief, this justification is accurate and complete. For those actions up to \$750,000, I approve contracting without competition for this requirement.

Brian D. Curl

Name

Brian D. Curl

Signature

04/04/2025

Date